sitting on the grass banks, especially on the eastern side. There is something about it that speaks to me, something I'm familiar with, the way the backdrop of mountains overlooking it goes to explaining the cricket pitch itself; the outside informing what's inside. It has a kind of humility, an unglorified everydayness, being essentially in the middle of a roundabout. It feels right. It just works.

Despite my ankle, despite what I'm told, I'm flooded with all the energy of a second chance. I am strapped up on painkillers and mental strength and say to the staff that I cannot let this chance go. This is a chance that needs to be taken despite the pain. I am going to go out there and bowl. I won't remember the pain, I will remember the wickets. I'm leading the attack again for England and nobody can stop me. As we take the field again, watching Ryan Sidebottom bowl his first over, I can feel again the energy and spirit of bowling a ball, just the sheer potential of it, of watching it do what it sometimes does by divine intervention, carrying me towards new possibility.

The early signs are good. The ball is doing that glorious, sweet thing. It's moving in the air every ball. Talking to me. Telling me that something is right. Matthew Bell is facing and I run in, taking off on the ankle and feeling its last complaint to me until I resurface from the delivery. All those ideas about my action banished, I'm simply thinking about nothing but doing what is most natural. The ball is perfect, another of those that appears like it's straight, squaring him up and teasing him into playing the ball as if it's going down the leg side, before straightening, transforming the batter into that little S in the air, and hitting the stumps. It's the sound of something new. A new start.

A few overs later, How is outside off stump, edging the ball to Andrew Strauss, who cushions it and then cartwheels his hands away, mouth wide open. I'm using the crease, feeling the help in the air and realising if I come from slightly wider, I can angle the ball into the batter and make them feel the need to play before making the ball leave them again. I get a few to Sinclair that he must play at, targeting his stumps, before hanging one slightly outside the off stump, one that he *feels* he has to play at. It's all deceit, sleight of hand. He's gone too. The score is 31/3, the reserve echoing with the Barmy Army singing the song. The throbbing ankle turns itself into a good feeling, letting me know I'm alive.